

Name Student: Marin van Meegen

Internship or Thesis: Thesis

Title project: Locating Numerosity Processing in the Visual System: An Interocular Transfer Experiment of Adaptation to Numerosity

Numerosity perception refers to the ability to rapidly estimate the number of non-numerical quantities in an environment and is considered a fundamental capacity to cognitive functions. However, it remains debated whether numerosity processing relies primarily on early visual representations or higher-cortical processes. The present study aimed to provide insight into this debate by investigating interocular transfer of adaptation to numerosity. The experimental design allowed for differentiation between monocular and binocular levels of processing of numerosity. Using a dichoptic viewing paradigm, 28 participants compared the numerosity of dot arrays following low (20 dots) or high (80 dots) adaptation to numerosity in monocular and interocular transfer viewing conditions. Results showed adaptation to low numerosity induced overestimation, whereas adaptation to high numerosity led to underestimation of numerosity. Importantly, the magnitude of the perceptual shift in numerosity induced by the aftereffects of adaptation stronger adaptation effects in monocular viewing conditions compared to interocular viewing. These findings suggests numerosity processing involves both monocular, early levels of visual processing as well as binocular, higher order levels of visual processing. Additionally, the results highlight the potential influence of low-level computations in the representation of numerosity perception. Overall, the study provides behavioural evidence suggesting numerosity perception to involve both early and high levels of visual processing.

Name company or University: Utrecht University

UU Supervisor: Prof. Dr. Maarten van der Smagt

Abstract

The increasing use of synthetic media has raised concerns about transparency and audience perceptions. This study examined how the timing of synthetic-media disclosure influences audience responses to a prosocial deepfake video promoting pro-environmental food choices. A 2×3 between-subjects experiment was conducted to manipulate disclosure timing and food message (pro-environmental vs. non-environmental). Believability, ethical evaluations, and attitudes toward the video were measured as dependent variables. Results indicated no significant effect of disclosure timing on believability. Additional analyses suggested that prior suspicion may have influenced believability judgments. However, disclosure timing significantly influenced both ethical evaluations and attitudes. Significant effects of food message were found across all dependent variables, with the pro-environmental message receiving more favorable evaluations. These findings provide insights into effective disclosure strategies for prosocial synthetic media.

129 words

Abstract

The research project will be regarding habitual versus goal directed control of behaviour. Specifically we want to know what happens when people are trained on an instrumental learning task to make specific responses to obtain a reward according to a dual process models of decision making repeatedly conducting this behavior would result in stimulus response habit and the anticipation of the outcome becomes increasing the less relevant previous studies have used outcome devaluation to test whether behavior becomes less driven by it anticipation of the outcome does it behavioral reader has some limitations. Therefore, we would like to use a different paradigm by stable perception to obtain an implicit measure of the strength of the outcome anticipation similar to bi-stable by stable spheres.

Abstract

Appearance-related concerns are prevalent in the general population, yet most research on body perception has focused on clinical populations. Body dysmorphic concerns (BDC) may offer a useful framework for studying these processes outside clinical settings, as they exist on a continuum from mild to severe. While BDC have primarily been examined at a cognitive-affective level, less is known about whether they are also reflected in body representation. The present study examined whether sport activity is associated with tactile body perception in a general population sample ($N = 40$) and whether BDC moderates this association. Participants completed the Dysmorphic Concern Questionnaire, the Baecke Habitual Physical Activity Questionnaire, and a Tactile Estimation Task. Neither sport activity nor BDC predicted tactile distortion, and no moderation effect was observed. Given the limited statistical power and low variability in BDC scores, these null findings should be interpreted cautiously. The results suggest that at subclinical levels, body image difficulties may primarily operate at a cognitive-affective rather than a perceptual level.

Keywords: body dysmorphic concerns, body representation, tactile estimation, sport activity, body perception

Name Student: Britt Waterman

Internship or Thesis: Thesis

Title project:

Long-Term Effects of Parent's Speech Quantity and Quality on Infant's Later Language Development.

The aim of the current study was to assess the longitudinal relationship between the quantity and quality of parents' child-directed speech (measured at age of 10 months) and infants' later language development (measured at 5,5 years). This relationship is mediated by a child's language processing skills, which is measured with the *Looking-While-Listening* (LWL) task (measured at 3,5 years). Variance in both quantity and quality of parents' speech has been linked to differences in children's vocabulary development. We expected that quality of parents' speech has a more long-term effect on language development than quantity. The mediation analysis showed no significant mediation of language processing between both quantity and quality and general language score. Quality showed a significant direct effect on language scores. We concluded that, over years of development, language processing loses its mediation effect, and quality of child-directed speech has a long-term effect on children's general language development.

Name company or University: Universiteit Utrecht

(If applicable) External supervisor: Not applicable

UU Supervisor: Caroline Junge

Name Student: Sofia Ferrer

Internship or Thesis: Thesis

Title project: Let's Stop and Think About AI: The Effect of Errors on Trust from Relevant Human vs. AI Decision-Support Systems

ABSTRACT

The present study investigated the cognitive mechanisms behind how errors from relevant AI versus human decision-support systems affect trust. Participants completed an online perceptual decision-making task in which they received advice from either an AI or a human decision-support system. On each trial, participants indicated whether they agreed or disagreed with the provided advice. Errors were systematically introduced by presenting incorrect advice, allowing examination of how reaction time, agreement, and accuracy adjusted following errors made by the advisor. Data collected from 24 participants revealed that reaction time was significantly longer when advice came from a human rather than an algorithm. Participants also agreed significantly more with human advisors. Post-error slowing effects were not significant across any conditions. The findings indicate that further research on how to use cognitive modeling theories in the field of trust in AI is necessary to extract meaningful conclusions about how algorithm aversion manifests on a cognitive level.

Keywords: Algorithm Aversion, Decision-Support System, Error-monitoring, Post-Error Slowing, Expectancy Effects, Cognitive Control

Name company or University: Utrecht University

UU Supervisor: Baptist Liefoghe & Leendert van Maanen

Name Student: Wieke Bakker

Internship or Thesis: Thesis

Title project: Does impulsivity moderate the relationship between arousal and sustained attention?

The relationship between arousal and sustained attention seems to follow an 'inverted U' shape. Both over- and under-arousal impair performance, and in between lies an optimal arousal level. There is some evidence that suggests that the more impulsive someone is, the lower their baseline arousal level is and the higher their optimal arousal level is for sustaining attention. However, not much research has been done to better understand how this relationship might differ for people who are high in impulsivity. I will therefore investigate whether impulsivity moderates the relationship between arousal and sustained attention. Impulsivity will be measured with the Barratt Impulsivity Scale, sustained attention with the auditory Continuous Temporal Expectancy Task, and arousal with EEG alpha power (inverse relationship). I plan on fitting an accumulation model to the reaction time data, to see if calculating a drift rate and boundary height help explain what processes underly the hypothesized difference.

Name company or University: Utrecht University

UU Supervisor: Daan van Rooij

Name Student: Clément Ligthart

Internship or Thesis: Thesis

Title project: The influence of Neuralgic Amyotrophy on multisensory integration and body ownership, using the Rubber-hand Illusion.

Abstract:

Neuralgic amyotrophy (NA) is a peripheral nerve disorder marked by acute brachial plexus inflammation, causing severe pain and upper-limb weakness. Although nerve damage often recovers, motor deficits can persist. Prior research suggests reduced activity in brain regions involved in multisensory integration and body ownership, which may improve with multidisciplinary treatment. This study examined differences between untreated NA patients, treated NA patients, and healthy controls using the Rubber Hand Illusion (RHI), assessing proprioceptive drift and body ownership across dominant and non-dominant sides and synchronous and asynchronous stimulation. Forty-two participants were included; all NA patients being affected on the dominant side. Contrary to expectations, no significant group differences emerged for proprioceptive drift or embodiment. However, the non-dominant limb showed greater disembodiment overall. Trends toward significance suggested possible group effects on proprioceptive drift and interactions involving synchronicity and limb side. These findings indicate that NA may subtly affect multisensory integration and body ownership, though conclusions are limited by the small sample size.

Name company or University: Utrecht University

UU Supervisor: Renee Lustenhouwer

Name Student: Julie Anna Tlustá

Internship or Thesis: Master Thesis ACP, ECTS: 27.5

Title project: Assessing Survey Items Through Cognitive Interviewing:

A Methodological Example Using the Wayfinding Tendencies Survey

Name company or University: Department of Experimental Psychology, Utrecht University

UU Supervisor: PhD Candidate Dominique Blokland (MSc/MA)

Abstract

Independent mobility is essential for societal participation and quality of life, however, for visually impaired people (VIP) navigation remains challenging. Orientation and mobility (O&M) training supports independent travel by tailoring teaching strategies to clients' wayfinding tendencies. Nevertheless, the absence of a standardised instrument to assess these differences limits the training's effectiveness. This thesis contributes to the development of a survey assessing navigational preferences and tendencies. Using cognitive interviewing (CI) with a think-aloud protocol, this study qualitatively examined the responses of three VIP and three O&M instructors to 75 survey items. Data were deductively analysed based on Tourangeau's 1984 cognitive model, focusing on difficulties across the model's four stages: comprehension, retrieval, judgment, and response. Most issues arose in the comprehension stage. Given this, recommendations were to revise 14 and remove 5 items. This study represents a step toward developing a standardised assessment tool for O&M practice, supporting a more tailored and effective training for VIP.

Name Student: Amber Koreman

Internship or Thesis: Thesis

Title project: Using AI as your therapist: Young Adults' Motivations to use ChatGPT and their Relation to Mental Health

Abstract:

ChatGPT is increasingly used by young adults for diverse purposes. However, there is concern about some of these reasons having a negative relationship with young adults' mental health. This thesis investigated the relationship between the different motivations to use ChatGPT and the users' well- and ill-being. Using the 'Uses and Gratifications' framework, five motivations were identified: information seeking, personalisation, playfulness, social interaction and task efficiency. A questionnaire on these motivations and mental health scales was used and received 50 responses. Regression analyses on the correlation between the motivations to use ChatGPT and mental health scales showed a negative relation for two motivations. Only using ChatGPT for task efficiency showed a positive relation to mental health. The implications of these outcomes are discussed regarding the need for regulations to reduce the use of ChatGPT for social-oriented outcomes and to educate young adults on the effects of using ChatGPT on mental health.

Name company or University: Dynamics of Youth: Becoming Adults in a Changing World

External supervisor: Alexandra Masciantonio

UU Supervisor: Chris Janssen

Name Student: Fotios-Konstantinos Perikleous

Internship or Thesis: internship

Title project: AI Voice Assistant for Collaborative Platforms (Abstract, 100-150 words)

Name company or University: CoVince

External supervisor: Richard van Tilborg

UU Supervisor: Dr. Anouk Keizer

Abstract:

During my internship at Covince, I explored how AI voice assistants can be effectively used in group conversations. Initially, the focus was on conducting a literature review and designing a pilot test to gather feedback from office colleagues on their reactions and preferences. Midway through the internship, the project shifted when a potential client was identified. The company began discussions with a general practitioner to explore implementing the AI assistant in doctor–patient conversations. Consequently, the project’s focus realigned to this application. During this period, I attended product presentations, tested demos, and gathered insights from potential clients. This experience provided practical exposure to both user-centered research and real-world product development, highlighting the challenges and opportunities of integrating AI assistants into collaborative professional environments.

Janna Spruijt

Thesis

Sensory Sensitivity and Prediction Error: Linking SPS, P1/P2, and Mismatch Negativity

The ability to efficiently process sensory input and detect changes in the environment is fundamental to human cognition. The mismatch negativity (MMN), an event-related potential (ERP), is widely used as a neural index of automatic auditory change detection and prediction error processing (the difference between expectation and input). Although previous research has linked MMN amplitude to various personality traits (e.g., impulsivity and extraversion), the relationship between sensory processing sensitivity (SPS) and MMN remains unexplored. The present study aims to investigate the extent to which self-reported SPS and early auditory ERP components (P1 and P2) relate to MMN amplitude. EEG data will be collected while participants perform an auditory novelty detection task, in which deviant tones are embedded in a sequence of standard tones. MMN amplitude will be derived from the difference between responses to standard and deviant stimuli, and P1/P2 amplitudes will be extracted as neural indices of early sensory processing.

Utrecht University

Sam van Bijnen

Name Student: Emma Harfterkamp

Internship or Thesis: Thesis

Title project: Where do microcars go?

Microcar driver knowledge of traffic signs, behavior and license type was explored in this thesis. Microcars have risen in popularity. There is concern for safety over incidents with microcars illegally driving on the bicycle(-moped) paths. It is unknown if these incidents are due to lack of knowledge or disregard for the law. We hypothesized that 1) microcar drivers are less knowledgeable of traffic sign meaning for microcars compared to cars and bicycles; 2) this knowledge would correlate to driver license type; 3) knowledge level would not correlate with reported behavior. We tested knowledge of different traffic signs among 77 microcar drivers by asking whether a car, bicycle or microcar were allowed to use roads under different traffic signs. We asked about license type and behavior. The results show microcar drivers have significantly less knowledge of traffic sign meaning for microcars than for bicycles and cars, indicated by a lower microcar score. License type showed no correlation with the scores. Behavior negatively correlated with total score and microcar score. This could be due to poor knowledge of traffic laws, or lack of reporting of illegal behavior. With this knowledge measures can be taken to ensure the safety of microcar drivers and other road-users.

Name company or University: XTNT

External supervisor: Gerard Tertoolen

UU Supervisor: Samson Chota

Emilie Broeders (2586207)

Thesis

The Association Between Sport Activity and Tactile Body Size Perception: Investigating Muscle Dysmorphia-Related Attitudes as a Moderator

This study investigated the relationship between sport activity and tactile body size perception, specifically examining whether muscle dysmorphia (MD)-related attitudes moderate this link. While sensory distortions are well-documented in eating disorders, research regarding muscularity-related concerns remains scarce. Forty young adults completed the Tactile Estimation Task (TET) to measure somatosensory processing and reported their habitual physical activity and MD-related attitudes. Hierarchical regression analyses revealed that neither sport activity nor MD-related attitudes significantly predicted tactile distortions. However, exploratory analyses showed a significant positive correlation between sport activity and MD-related attitudes. These findings suggest a dissociation between high-level cognitive evaluations and low-level somatosensory processing in a non-clinical sample. Future longitudinal research is needed to determine if long-term training intensity eventually alters the internal body model.

Utrecht University, Applied Cognitive Psychology

Dr. Anouk Keizer

Name Student: Muhammad Danish Khoo

Student number: 8466017

Internship/Thesis: Internship

Yelling at Devices: Failure Attribution and Performance Experience in Pinball Play

Failure is an important aspect of play, yet how players emotionally experience and interpret failure remains poorly understood. This study investigates how failure attribution shapes emotional responses in pinball play. In a within-session observational study conducted across two on-site festivals (N=326), participants played one of two pinball machines before completing questionnaires on their emotions and internal attribution. Results – analysed using Python – showed that while failure route had limited influence on valence and arousal, it significantly affected perceived control. Critically, internality was a positive predictor of all three emotional outcomes, independent of the objective performance indicators of pinball play – score and time. This relationship was moderated by failure route, with the buffering effect of internal attribution being strongest when failure was framed as a clear mistake, and significantly weaker for outlane and straight-down-the-middle endings. These findings suggest that how failure is framed – not how well a player performs – is key to shaping the emotional experience of play. Promoting a healthier form of play thereby warrants further discussions into failure framing.

Company/University: Utrecht University, Centre for Game Research

External supervisor: Sander Bakkes (s.c.j.bakkes@uu.nl)

UU Supervisor: Leendert van Maanen (l.vanmaanen@uu.nl)

Name: Sonia Yi

Internship or thesis: Thesis

Title Project: Cerebellar Mechanisms in Reward Anticipation and Outcome:
The Role of Motivational Traits

Abstract:

Reward anticipation and outcome processing are central components of motivated behavior and adaptive learning. Although the cerebellum has traditionally been associated with motor control, growing evidence suggests that it also contributes to reward-related and predictive cognitive processes. However, the extent to which cerebellar involvement in reward processing is modulated by individual differences in motivational traits remains unclear. The present study aims to investigate cerebellar mechanisms underlying reward anticipation and outcome processing, and to examine how motivational traits influence these neural responses. Healthy participants will complete a reward anticipation-reward omission task while EEG is recorded. Neural markers associated with reward expectation, outcome evaluation, and prediction error will be examined. Individual differences in motivational traits, including rewards sensitivity and approach motivation, will be assessed using the Behavioral Inhibition System/Behavioral Activation System, (BIS/BAS) questionnaire. Primary analyses will focus on associations between motivational traits and neural responses during reward anticipation and outcome.

Name of company or university: Utrecht University

UU Supervisor: Dennis J.L.G. Schutter

Name Student: Gunes Kabel

Internship or Thesis: Thesis

Title project: Emotional Habituation to Repeated Visual Media Exposure: Valence-Dependent Effects of Positive and Negative Stimuli

This study investigates emotional habituation to repeated visual stimuli and examines whether daily social media use influences this process. Habituation refers to a decrease in behavioural and physiological responses following repeated exposure to stimuli, and it plays a key role in adaptive emotional functioning. While emotional stimuli are known to elicit stronger initial responses than neutral stimuli, findings remain mixed regarding differences in habituation across emotional valences. Additionally, despite the highly visual and repetitive nature of social media, its relationship with emotional habituation is not well understood. In this study, 30 participants completed an emotional habituation task while their EEG activity was recorded. Participants were repeatedly exposed to pleasant, unpleasant, and neutral images selected from the International Affective Picture System (IAPS). Habituation was measured through changes in Late Positive Potential (LPP) amplitudes and subjective arousal ratings across repeated presentations. Following the task, participants completed a questionnaire assessing their social media usage and exposure to emotional content. It is expected that emotional stimuli will show stronger habituation compared to neutral stimuli, with unpleasant stimuli habituating faster than pleasant stimuli. Furthermore, higher levels of social media use are predicted to be associated with faster rates of emotional habituation.

Name of University: Utrecht University

UU Supervisor: Dennis Schutter d.j.l.g.schutter@uu.nl

Isabelle Brianna Cowie

0859974

ACP Master's Thesis

**Expertise, Attention, and Sensorimotor Gating: Differences in Prepulse Inhibition
Between Surgeons and Medical Interns**

Abstract

The dynamic nature of stimulus-rich surgical environments places high demands on the attentional resources of surgeons. Effective attentional filtering is imperative to reduce medical error and thereby improve patient outcomes. This pilot investigates whether surgical experts differ from untrained individuals in their prepulse inhibition levels during a non-specific task. BlinkLab, a neurobehavioral testing system, was used to measure prepulse inhibition in surgeons (expert group) versus medical interns (untrained group) pre- and post-shift. Data collection is ongoing, and planned analyses will assess both between-group and within-group differences. This pilot aims to evaluate whether a definitive investigation with an expanded sample size is warranted, while contributing to understanding of attentional filtering across surgical practice and training contexts.

Institute of Medical Education Research in Rotterdam (iMERR), EMC

In collaboration with the Innovation Lab and BlinkLab of EMC

External supervisor: Dario Cecilio-Fernandes, PhD

UU Supervisor: Samson Chota, PhD

Hanna Maciejka
Thesis

The influence of positive and neutral expectations on emotion regulation ability following placebo brain stimulation.

Expectations about transcranial direct current stimulation (tDCS) can influence outcomes, even during sham stimulation, with positive expectations often enhancing performance. Simultaneously, tDCS has been shown to modulate emotional regulation, including cognitive reappraisal, however, it remains unclear whether expectancy effects influence this process. This study examined whether expectation priming influences cognitive reappraisal success following sham tDCS. Participants were assigned to either a positive or neutral expectation priming condition and completed a cognitive reappraisal task before and after sham stimulation. During the task, they viewed negative images, with the instruction to either look or reappraise their emotions, followed by ratings of their affect along two dimensions, arousal and valence. The results revealed that positive expectations about tDCS can lead to improved cognitive reappraisal ability, even in the absence of active stimulation. Conversely, neutral expectations resulted in lower reappraisal success after the stimulation. The findings provide preliminary evidence that expectations may influence emotion regulation ability following sham tDCS.

Utrecht University
Jana Klaus

Name: Yuting Feng

Type: Thesis Project

Project: The Role of Expectation in Placebo Effect on Emotion Regulation Following sham tDCS

University: Utrecht University

Supervisor: Dr. Jana. Klaus

Abstract

The present study aimed to examine whether expectancy influences the placebo effect on emotion regulation following sham tDCS. Expectancy refers to individuals' beliefs about the effectiveness of an intervention. Participants ($N = 15$) completed a facial emotional Stroop task before and after sham stimulation. Expectancy was manipulated between groups (positive vs. neutral). The results revealed a significant main effect of time, indicating faster reaction times at endpoints compared to baseline. However, no significant effects involving the expectancy group were observed. Overall, the results do not support the hypothesis that expectancy influences emotion regulation performance under sham tDCS conditions.

Keywords: placebo effect, expectancy, sham tDCS, emotion regulation

Name Student: Lucas Vaarzon Morel

Internship or Thesis: Thesis

Title project: Does Timing Matter? Deepfake Disclosure and Value Congruency in Prosocial Advertising

Abstract:

This study examines how value congruency and synthetic media-disclosure timing influence ethical evaluations of deepfake advertisements promoting (un)sustainable food consumption. This study was conducted using a 2 (food message: pro-environmental vs. anti-environmental) $\times$ 3 (synthetic-media disclosure timing: before vs. during vs. after exposure) between-subjects factorial design. Participants watched a deepfake advertisement of a celebrity chef promoting either pro- or anti-environmental food consumption, with synthetic media disclosure presented at different timings. Results from a hierarchical regression analysis showed no significant interaction effects between value congruency and disclosure timing. Value congruency was a significant positive predictor of ethical evaluations, regardless of disclosure timing or food message condition. These findings suggest that an individual's personal values play a dominant role in shaping ethical evaluations, while disclosure timing and food message have little impact. This study contributes to research on synthetic media usage in prosocial advertising by showing the importance of aligning persuasive messages with consumers' values to enhance ethical evaluations.

Name company or University: Utrecht University

UU Supervisor: R.J. Weijers

Name Student: Lesly Emilia Badtke (l.e.badtke@gmail.com)

Internship or Thesis: Thesis

Title Project: Physiological responses in defense transition: The role of trait guilt and anxiety.

Abstract

The current study investigates the relationship between defensive response transitions and dynamic changes in physiological activity. The assumed framework builds upon the idea of threat imminence, in which agents evaluate threat based on perceived closeness and react accordingly, switching from freeze to fight-or-flight. Considering the role that negative emotions such as guilt play in reaction to threat, especially in individuals with anxiety disorders, the mediating role of guilt was also accounted for. For this purpose, participants were asked to complete a virtual predator escape task under the threat of a non-painful electric shock. Three conditions were set for the trials: a safe condition, an escapable threat condition and an inescapable threat condition. The results are expected to show physiological data patterns consistent with the threat imminence continuum in the threat conditions, with an increase in skin conductance and muscle activity in the circa-strike phase, as well as an initial decrease in heart-rate in the post-encounter typical of a freezing response. Data will be modeled using Bayesian regression analysis.

Name company or University: Utrecht University

(If applicable) External supervisor: N/A

UU Supervisor: Joana Barbosa Vieira (j.m.barbosavieira@uu.nl)

Name Student: YingQi Hu

Internship or Thesis: Thesis

Title project: Onboarding Experiences in a Multinational Organization: How Cultural Background and Organizational Culture Shape New Hires' Expectations at Philips

This study explores how cultural background and organizational culture interact during the onboarding process in a multinational organization. While onboarding practices are often standardized across global contexts, employees may enter with different expectations regarding structure, communication, and support. Using an embedded qualitative-led mixed-methods design, this research combines existing onboarding survey data, open-ended survey responses and qualitative interviews with new hires at Philips. The findings indicate that onboarding was generally experienced as positive and supportive, reflecting a strong and consistent organizational culture. Cultural differences were not always explicitly perceived, variation emerged mainly in expectations for guidance, clarity, and autonomy during early role integration. Cultural background did not directly determine onboarding outcomes but influenced how organizational practices were interpreted in specific situations. The study highlights the importance of maintaining a shared onboarding framework while allowing flexibility to address diverse expectations within multinational organizations.

Name company or University: Philips

External supervisor: Alexandra Ursu

UU Supervisor: Gabriël Beckers

Name Student: Daidipya Mane

Internship or Thesis: Internship

Title project: The Attention Blueprint: What Makes Creative Assets Actually Work

This report enhances Brandpulse Analytics' creative asset pre-testing service by enabling the company to explain *why* client assets capture attention, not just *which* ones perform best. Previously, clients received test results without actionable insights for future creative development. So, through a systematic review of neuroscientific and psychological literature on bottom-up attention, 17 key visual features were identified as robust attention-drivers. Therefore, this report is a structured framework containing: (1) the attention-driving features, (2) evidence-based explanations of how each influences attention, (3) visual examples of each, and (4) supporting literature references. Recommendations for improving pre-testing methodology and statistical analysis were also provided. This framework allows Brandpulse to transform client reports from simple performance rankings into science-backed recommendations, extending value beyond individual projects by enabling clients to optimise future creative assets independently.

Name company or University: Brandpulse Analytics B.V.

(If applicable) External supervisor: Arno Kooijman (arno@brandpulse-analytics.com)

UU Supervisor: Dr. Daan van Rooij

Name: Annelot Ritsma, 2531844, a.l.ritsma@students.uu.nl

Internship/thesis: Thesis

Title: *Assessing the suitability of Open AI's WhisperX for transcribing infant-direct speech in early language development research*

Transcribing parent-infant interactions is an essential but time-consuming task in early developmental language research. With technological advances in AI, automatic speech recognition tools (ASR) such as OpenAI's WhisperX are increasingly being used as an alternative to manual transcriptions. However, it remains unclear how well these tools perform when applied to infant-directed speech (IDS), which differs from adult-directed speech in vocabulary as well as the tone of speaking. This thesis evaluates accuracy of WhisperX when transcribing IDS produced by parents of 10-month-old infants. Using video recordings from Bravechild/YOUthCohort at UU, automated transcriptions generated by WhisperX are compared to human-corrected transcriptions. These are assessed through Word Error Rate (WER) and an exploratory error analysis, to examine whether errors are systematic based on linguistic characteristics relevant to IDS. By combining overall accuracy measures with an error analysis, this study assesses whether WhisperX can be responsibly used in developmental language research.

University: Utrecht University

UU Supervisor: Anika van der Klis

Program: Applied Cognitive Psychology